How to use this Beamer template

A guide to Loom

Your Name

Your Organization

Template guide

Design inspired by Loom by Polaris.

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SECTION 01

Getting started

Project files

File	Purpose
`starter.tex`	A short presentation to copy and edit
`main.tex`	This tutorial, including speaker notes
`beamerthemeLoom.sty`	Colors, typography, and slide layouts
`loomnotes.sty`	Notes on the right, with aligned hyperlinks
`main-notes.tex`	Builds the tutorial with speaker notes
`main-handout.tex`	Builds one page per frame

The first build

Use a TeX distribution with XeLaTeX and `latexmk`.

From the template directory:

```
latexmk main.tex
latexmk main-notes.tex
```

Audience `build/main.pdf`

Presenter `build/main-notes.pdf`

`latexmk` repeats compilation until navigation and page counts settle.

Presentation metadata

Change these fields in the preamble:

```
\title[Short title]{Your presentation title}
\subtitle{Your subtitle}
\author{Your Name}
\institute{Your Organization}
\date{\today}
```

Short title Appears in the footer.

Cover Use `[plain,noframenumbering]` on its frame.

SECTION 02

Writing slides

A basic frame

```
\begin{frame}{A clear title}
  State the main point.
  \begin{itemize}
    \item Give one supporting detail.
    \item Give another if needed.
  \end{itemize}
  \note{Explain the point, then connect it to the next slide.}
\end{frame}
```

Each `frame` is one numbered slide. Its overlays can occupy several PDF pages.

Sections and navigation

```
\section[Methods]{Methods and assumptions}
\subsection[Model]{Model and objective}
```

- Section names populate the contents and top navigation.
- The short subsection name appears in the footer.
- Each dot links to a frame. Overlays keep the same frame number.

A section divider appears automatically. Use `nosectionpages` to disable it.

Columns and tables

Two-column layout

```
\begin{columns}[T,onlytextwidth]
  \begin{column}{.47\textwidth}
    Left content
  \end{column}
  \begin{column}{.47\textwidth}
    Right content
  \end{column}
\end{columns}
```

Table example

Element	Command
Top rule	`\toprule`
Header rule	`\midrule`
Bottom rule	`\bottomrule`

The theme loads `booktabs`. Keep column widths below the available space.

Mathematics and theorem blocks

Source

```
\begin{theorem}[Nonnegative norm]
  For every $x\in\mathbb{R}^d$,
  \[
    \|x\|_2^2=x^\top x\geq 0.
  \]
\end{theorem}
```

Theorem 1 (Nonnegative norm)

For every $x \in \mathbb{R}^d$,

$$\|x\|_2^2 = x^\top x \geq 0.$$

Standard `definition`, `example`, and `proof` environments also work.

Emphasis and blocks

Light emphasis Use `\loomkeyterm` for a short label.

A result

Use a standard `block` for a statement that needs visual emphasis.

A limitation

Use `alertblock` for a condition or warning.

An example

Use `exampleblock` for a short illustration.

SECTION 03

Notes and presentation

Speaker notes

Put the spoken explanation inside the corresponding frame:

```
\note{Explain the main point in a few sentences.
Then connect it to the next slide.}
```

Build `latexmk main-notes.tex`

The notes PDF places the slide on the left and notes on the right.

Use a presenter application that supports split-page PDFs. Share only the audience half.

Optional reveals

These two blocks demonstrate a cumulative overlay:

First point

```
\begin{loomstepblock}<1->{First point}
```

Second point

```
\begin{loomstepalert}<2->{Second point}
```

Omit overlay specifications to show all content together.

Audience, notes, and handouts

```
latexmk main.tex
latexmk main-notes.tex
latexmk main-handout.tex
```

Output file	Use
`main.pdf`	Audience slides, including reveals
`main-notes.pdf`	Slides with speaker notes on the right
`main-handout.pdf`	One page per frame, without notes

SECTION 04

Customizing the template

Logo, color, and typography

The template has no institutional logo by default.

```
% Use artwork you have permission to share.
\setloomlogofile{assets/your-logo.pdf}
% Or hide the cover graphic:
\setloomtitlegraphic{}

% Local appearance overrides, after \usetheme{Loom}:
\setbeamercolor{structure}{fg=loomMadder}
\setbeamerfont{frametitle}{size=\Large}
```

XeLaTeX uses Libertinus when available, with TeX font fallbacks.

Before you present

1. Compile the audience and notes versions.
2. Check every slide for clipped text and crowded equations.
3. Test the section links and incremental reveals.
4. Confirm that the audience cannot see your notes.

For a new talk Copy `starter.tex`.

For more options See `README.md`.